YouTube Content Strategy

Pipeline Type: Automated Narrative (Research → Script → AI Voice → AI Images → Voiceover)
Tone: Technical Visionary, Skeptical Auditor, Failure Forward
Format: 3-5 minute narrative videos (concept + images + voiceover, minimal text)
Updated: April 5, 2026

Category 1: Build & Fail (Post-Mortem Series)

Summary:
Focused on your actual shipping history—projects that succeeded technically but failed economically, or projects you abandoned. This category leans into your "failure forward" philosophy. These are the most authentic topics because you lived them. Low effort (you already know the story), high relatability (people recognize themselves in these failures), strong audience appeal (everyone fails; nobody talks about it honestly).

Why This Category Works:

- You have real data (PhantomArbiter: 400 trades, -$4.23; rpgCore → OperatorGame pivot)
- Audiences hunger for honest post-mortems (not sanitized success stories)
- Connects to your brand discipline: documenting what works and what doesn't
- Natural fit for the narrative pipeline (story arc: problem → attempt → lesson)

Topic	Why It Interests You	Potential Audience	Effort	Narrative Arc
The -$4.23 Trading Bot: A Post-Mortem	PhantomArbiter. 1,891 commits, 400 live trades. System worked flawlessly. Math didn't.	Crypto skeptics, aspiring bot builders, DeFi learners	Low	Ambition → Technical Success → Economic Reality Check
Why I Abandoned My First Game Engine	rpgCore pivot to OperatorGame. Why you left 1,122 tests behind.	Indie game devs, software architects, system designers	Low	Overengineering → Ceiling Hit → Strategic Pivot
Confessions of a Self-Taught IT Manager	Phone sales → IT automation. What worked, what was messy, what you learned.	Career switchers, no-degree builders, self-taught developers	Medium	Imposter Syndrome → Real Impact → Confidence
The 'Goldilocks' Feature: Over-Engineering for No One	Why you built features nobody asked for. ROI of saying "no" to cool ideas.	Project managers, solo founders, indie creators	Medium	Vision → Overbuilding → Scope Lock Lesson
Public Failure as a Career Catalyst	How documenting mistakes at Consumr Buzz built more trust than success stories.	Professional developers, content creators, builders	Low	Vulnerability → Trust → Community

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Category 2: Systems & Automation (Operational Efficiency)

Summary:
Your core competency. These topics explore how to build systems that solve real friction—and what happens when you do. This category is grounded in your day job at Consumr Buzz and your exploration of automation frameworks. Medium effort (research + your experience), strong monetization signal (ops/IT teams pay for solutions), direct connection to your brand discipline (solving friction systematically).

Why This Category Works:

- You have production systems and real ROI data
- Audience is practical (they have actual problems to solve)

- Positions you as both engineer AND operator (rare credibility)
- Fits the narrative pipeline (problem → system → outcome)

Topic	Why It Interests You	Potential Audience	Effort	Narrative Arc
The Invisible Employee: Automating 60% of a Job	Your actual Consumr Buzz impact. Lead processing, dialer balancing, scheduler workflows. Real numbers.	Office workers, IT admins, operations managers, data teams	Low	Manual Chaos → Systematic Automation → Freed-Up Time
Architecture for the Lazy: The KISS Principle in 2026	Your philosophy: complexity is the enemy. Simple systems win.	Junior developers, system designers, architects	Medium	Overengineering Trap → Simplicity as Power → Real Examples
When Python is Overkill: The Power of the Side-Step	Sometimes the answer isn't automation—it's rethinking the problem.	Automation engineers, data admins, operations	Medium	Automation Addiction → Problem Reframing → Elegant Solutions
The Ghost in the Data: Why 20M Leads Need a Shepherd	Data pipelines at scale. Centralized database strategy. Governance without bureaucracy.	Data engineers, DBAs, enterprise IT	High	Data Chaos → Pipeline Architecture → Governance Model
Death by Dashboard: Why Most Monitoring is Useless	Observability theater. Why most dashboards don't help. What actually works.	SysAdmins, DevOps engineers, infrastructure teams	Medium	Alert Fatigue → Signal vs. Noise → Effective Monitoring

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Category 3: Game Design & Mechanics (Narrative-Driven)

Summary:
Game design from first principles. These topics are perfect for your image-heavy pipeline because they're concept-driven, not gameplay-demonstration-driven. You explore *why* mechanics work, not *how* to build them. Medium effort (research required, but you have

gameplay experience), niche but passionate audience, strong creative signal (shows depth beyond just shipping).

Why This Category Works:

- Image-heavy narrative works perfectly for design theory
- You have rpgCore + OperatorGame + TurboShells as reference material
- Game design audiences are hungry for mechanical analysis
- Positions you as both builder AND analyst

Topic	Why It Interests You	Potential Audience	Effort	Narrative Arc
The 'Slot Machine' Myth in Game Design	Why roguelikes and deck-builders feel different from gambling. Luck vs. agency.	Game designers, game theorists, psychology enthusiasts	Medium	Addiction Mechanics → Agency-Based Design → Psychological Hooks
Simulating Chaos: Why Systems Trump Stories	Your preference for mechanics over flavor text. Procedural beats handcrafted.	Simulation game fans, engine developers (Bevy/Rust), systems designers	High	Narrative Overload → Mechanical Emergence → Player Agency
OperatorGame: Designing the 'Boring' Parts of IT	Why IT operations can be fun. Technical realism as game design.	Niche simulation fans, tech workers, indie designers	Low	Simulation Disdain → Hidden Depth → Unexpected Fun
The Evolution of the Rogue-lite Ecosystem	How deck-builders, roguelikes, and procedural games converged. Design patterns across genres.	General gamers, industry analysts, design students	Medium	Genre Fragmentation → Mechanic Convergence → Design Patterns
Why We Love Losing: The Cult of Difficulty	Failure loops as engagement. Why hard games build communities.	Hardcore gamers, game critics, community analysts	Medium	Accessibility Debate → Failure as Feature → Community Bonding

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Category 4: AI & The Future of Work (Technical Visionary)

Summary:
Your direct experience with AI tooling (Claude, Gemini, ElevenLabs, OpenRouter). These topics move past "ChatGPT tutorials" into real workflows—how AI changes systems and process. Medium effort (you're living this now), explosive audience growth (AI is the attention currency), strong positioning (you're using it as infrastructure, not gimmick).

Why This Category Works:

- You're an early adopter with real systems (ContentEngine, OpenAgent, pair programming)
- Audience is vast and hungry for honest takes
- Positions you as engineer-using-AI, not AI-expert
- Natural connection to your automation discipline

Topic	Why It Interests You	Potential Audience	Effort	Narrative Arc
Pair Programming with a Ghost: The AI Reality	How you actually work with Claude/Gemini. Three-layer execution model. Real workflow, not theory.	AI early adopters, Python/Rust developers, systems thinkers	Low	AI Hype → Practical Workflow → Architectural Patterns
Beyond the Prompt: Building AI-First Workflows	Moving past chat into automated pipelines (ContentEngine, OpenAgent, directives).	Tech entrepreneurs, builders, automation engineers	Medium	Prompt Engineering Ceiling → System Design → Agentic Architecture
The Death of the Bootcamp?	Self-directed learning vs. formal education. Your actual path (certifications + shipping).	Students, career switchers, lifelong learners, educators	High	Bootcamp Industry → Self-Directed Reality → Alternative Paths
Synthetic Creativity: Can AI Build a Better World?	AI-generated images/voice in your pipeline. What's real, what's hype.	Media theorists, digital artists, creators, philosophers	Medium	AI-Generated Art Skepticism → Practical Tools → Artistic Integration
The Skeptical Auditor's Guide to AI Hype	ROI of AI vs. infrastructure overhead. When to use AI, when it's snake oil.	Corporate leadership, IT managers, skeptics	Medium	AI Gold Rush → Reality Check → Practical Decision-Making

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Category 5: Deep Dives (Research-Heavy, High-Value)

Summary:
Topics that require significant research but align with your voice and offer unique angles. These are the "authority-building" category—you become the expert by doing the research thoroughly. High effort (research + synthesis), smaller but highly engaged audience, strong credibility signal.

Why This Category Works:

- Differentiates you from quick-take creators
- Positions you as thorough researcher, not just reactor

- Audience self-selects as serious learners
- Creates evergreen content (stays relevant for years)

Topic	Why It Interests You	Potential Audience	Effort	Narrative Arc
The Rust Revolution in Game Engines	Why you chose Rust + egui for OperatorGame. Rust vs. Unity/Unreal. Systems programming in games.	Performance engineers, engine developers, game dev communities	High	Performance Ceiling → Language Design → Paradigm Shift
DeFi 2.0: Lessons from the Rubble	Your crypto post-mortem mindset applied to the wider DeFi ecosystem. What failed, what remains.	Finance enthusiasts, blockchain developers, traders	High	DeFi Explosion → Market Collapse → Lessons Learned
The Architecture of Modern Privacy	Data administration ethics. Lead management governance. What "privacy by design" actually means.	Security professionals, privacy advocates, regulators	High	Privacy Theater → Technical Architecture → Real Protection
Minimalist Tech: The Art of Doing More with Less	KISS principle across hardware, software, operations. Less is harder.	Minimalists, efficiency enthusiasts, sustainable tech advocates	Medium	Complexity Trap → Intentional Reduction → Maximum Impact
The 'Ready-to-Play' Economy	Friction-less tech as competitive advantage. Why some products succeed, others fail.	Retro gamers, side-hustlers, product designers	Low	Onboarding Friction → User Retention → Economic Model
The Loneliness of the Self-Directed Learner	Psychological side of building alone. Community vs. isolation. Imposter syndrome.	Solo founders, independent developers, creatives	Medium	Isolation → Community Search → Building in Public
Legacy Systems: The Digital Archaeological Dig	Modernizing old systems. Why legacy code matters. Reverse engineering as learning.	Enterprise IT, data scientists, systems archaeologists	Medium	Technical Debt → Institutional Knowledge → Modernization Strategy

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Quick Navigation

Start Here (Low Effort, High Resonance):

- The -$4.23 Trading Bot: A Post-Mortem
- Why I Abandoned My First Game Engine
- The Invisible Employee: Automating 60% of a Job
- OperatorGame: Designing the 'Boring' Parts of IT
- Pair Programming with a Ghost: The AI Reality

Most Unique (Differentiation):

- The Ghost in the Data
- Simulating Chaos: Why Systems Trump Stories
- The Skeptical Auditor's Guide to AI Hype
- DeFi 2.0: Lessons from the Rubble

Fastest to Audience Growth:

- Pair Programming with a Ghost
- The Death of the Bootcamp?
- The Skeptical Auditor's Guide to AI Hype

Most Aligned with Brand Discipline:

- The Invisible Employee
- Architecture for the Lazy
- The -$4.23 Trading Bot
- When Python is Overkill

Next Steps

1. **Pick 3 topics** from "Start Here" that make you think "yeah, I have thoughts on that"
2. **Run one through ContentEngine** to validate the pipeline with real content
3. **Post it. See what happens.**
4. **Iterate** based on what resonates

The strategy is the container. The actual work is making one video and learning from it.

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